

# DE Shaw

The hiring process consisted of four rounds

1. Online test
2. Technical Interview - I (Online)
3. Technical Interview - II (Physical)
4. HR Interview

## Online Test :

Platform : HackerRank  
Time : 60 mins

The test consisted of 2 questions :

- i) A slight modification of checking whether two strings are anagrams of each other

<https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/problems/anagram-1587115620/1>

- ii) The question goes like, there are n chemicals numbered from 1 to n. We'll be given a vector of pairs indicating the chemicals in pairs. Let there be 10 chemicals and a pair be {3,6}, this means 3 doesn't mix with any chemical greater than or equal to 6 and similarly 6 doesn't mix with any chemical greater than or equal to 3. We have to identify the total number of possible valid mixtures. This question involves basic permutations and combinations while avoiding the invalid mixtures.

PS : I was able to pass  $\frac{3}{4}$  of the test cases.

From the Online Assessment, 20 people were shortlisted.

## Technical Interview - I (Online)

Platform : Code Pair  
Time : 60 mins

I was asked three questions - both coding and theory questions

- i) A slight modification of activity selection problem

<https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/problems/activity-selection-1587115620/1>

ii) I was asked to just explain how page scheduling works and what data structures are used in implementing different scheduling algorithms.

iii) A standard question to sort an array composed of 0,1 and 2 was asked

<https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/problems/sort-an-array-of-0s-1s-and-2s4231/1>

After I gave an approach involving three pointers, I was asked what I would do if I didn't know that the numbers were 0,1 and 2 in prior. (i.e) They can be any three numbers,say 11,54,45 etc. I was able to give an approach and they were happy with that.

7 people were shortlisted for the next round.

## Technical Interview - II (Physical)

i) I was asked the approach of standard DP problem - Word break - I and II

<https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/problems/word-break1352/1>

<https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/problems/word-break-part-23249/1>

ii) I was asked basic questions like what is unit and integration testing. When they went deeply into testing, I admitted that I don't have much knowledge on the domain. Then they gave a scenario which goes like,

People at a company work in 3 domains - a,b,c and each domain has exactly 50 commits everyday, say (a1 - a50), (b1-b50), (c1-c50). We have a testing machine which takes the input of form (i,j,k) where i denotes the commit number of a, j of b and k of c. The machine runs for an hour to tell whether there is a bug till this number of commits from all three domains - (Output is only true or false). At max, only one bug occurs everyday. What is the minimum time taken for you to use the machine and exactly alert the developer of a particular domain to look at that bug at a particular commit.

Soln : This is actually a simpler problem since the max possible bug is only one. You can start the input like (25,25,25) and if the machine returns true, the bug is possibly on the 25th commit of any of the domains or on a commit below. Else you can search above. At the end we'll have a set of commits where there is a bug. Say (11,11,11) happens to have the bug. Now we change the commit number of each domain and finally detect the bugged commit along with the domain.

iii) I was asked about writing objects to file in Java. I was also asked to generally talk about software updates. Like, why is an update necessary? What goes behind doing an update? How do we rollback to a previous update? How to have all previous working versions stored? - stuff like that. I was also asked to describe my projects and they picked one and I explained it in detail.

## HR Round :

Everyone who were selected for Technical round - II were asked to participate in the HR Round. The HR gave insights into the company and the type of work we'll be doing. And basic HR questions were asked like -

- I. Tell me about yourself, followed by elaborating all the adjectives that I used to describe myself.
- II. Any noteworthy achievements in college?
- III. What are the factors you prioritise when you take up a job?
- IV. Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- V. Small time goals and long time goals?
- VI. If you're offered with a SD or QA role in the company what would you take? (We were interviewed for a QA Engineer)
- VII. Are you feasible in working in an environment with diverse communities and practices?

The round was to basically assess one's behaviour, so try to answer accordingly. It is advised to look at the HR questions in interviewbit.

<https://www.interviewbit.com/hr-interview-questions/>

2 of us got selected at the end.

## Youtube Channels:

- Jenny's Lectures
- TechDose
- TakeUForward
- Sudhakar Atchala (OS)
- GateSmashers

## Platforms :

- GFG
- Leetcode
- Coding ninjas
- HackerRank for contest

These were my preferences, try all the available platforms and sources to learn and stick with what works for you.

## General Tips :

Not everyone is a born coder. Coding comes by practice and muscle memory plays a major role. Be patient, consistent, disciplined and you can see yourself getting better. Don't lose hope. With constant practice you can definitely crack the coding rounds.

Try to take extra 2-5 mins after solving each problem to recall the approach, figuring out time and space complexities.

It is completely normal to forget the solutions, never guilt trip about that. Visit the problems again.

Make sure you solve all the standard problems :

GFG SDE Sheet:

[https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/explore?page=1&curated\[\]=1&sortBy=submissions&curated\\_names\[\]=SDE%20Sheet](https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/explore?page=1&curated[]=1&sortBy=submissions&curated_names[]=SDE%20Sheet)

Love Babbar Sheet :

[https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/explore?page=1&curated\[\]=7&sortBy=submissions&curated\\_names\[\]=Love%20Babbar%20Sheet](https://practice.geeksforgeeks.org/explore?page=1&curated[]=7&sortBy=submissions&curated_names[]=Love%20Babbar%20Sheet)

Before attending a company make sure you have solved all of the previous year questions available.

In interviews, play to your strengths. If you're good at the domain you're questioned about try to answer the best way possible giving something extra for every answer. This may result in the follow up questions also being desirable for you.

If you have no idea or experience in a domain say System design, it is good to accept that you have no knowledge on this. This helps the interviewer to evaluate whether you're good at what you know.

Keep the interview process interactive and ask doubts if you don't understand the questions clearly. Make sure you're calm and composed throughout the interview process.

All the Best.

This is Gokul B from CEG CSE of batch 2023.

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